

Veteran's Outdoor Therapy Snagging Event MAR 2026

Getting out on the water with Veterans Outdoor Therapy was an incredible experience. There's a unique and powerful sense of connection that comes from being with fellow veterans. We didn't need to explain our pasts; we just understood. We spent the weekend sharing stories, laughing, and enjoying the simple pleasure of fishing. It was more than a trip—it was a reminder of the brotherhood that stays with us long after we take off the uniform. I am incredibly grateful to this organization for creating these opportunities.

MSG (R) James Peoples
Army
Purple Heart Recipient

Seeing how everyone changed from feeling unsure at first arrival, to having awesome and exciting conversations on the second evening really opened my eyes to the great thing VOT is. Vets helping Vets. The fishing was fun and we got some good ones, but the camaraderie we all partook in was “oh so good.” I look forward to helping more in the future.

Aaron Mattox, Army

I had the opportunity to participate in Veterans Outdoor Therapy's annual paddlefish snagging trip in March 2025, and it was an experience I won't forget.

Being able to get outdoors and connect with other combat veterans who have faced similar challenges was incredibly meaningful. There's something different about being around people who truly understand what you've been through without having to explain it. The camaraderie, support, and shared experiences made a lasting impact on me.

The entire trip was well organized, and the environment they created allowed everyone to relax, open up, and just enjoy the moment. It was more than just a fishing trip—it was a chance to reset, reconnect, and be part of a community again.

Because of how much this experience meant to me, I've volunteered to help with the 2026 snagging trip. I want to be part of giving other veterans the same opportunity that meant so much to me.

I highly recommend Veterans Outdoor Therapy to any veteran looking for connection, support, and a chance to get back outdoors with people who understand.

Chris Shoaf, Army

This trip was needed so much more than I realized. It was great to get away with like minded individuals. I didn't catch anything, but to me it wasn't about that, it was about sharing time with other soldiers again. I didn't really think I deserved to be chosen, but I'm so grateful I was. It did so much for my mind. Thank you so much for the opportunity. Truly appreciated!

Dustin Smith, Army
Purple Heart Recipient